The Nonviolence Premium: Cross-National Evidence from 166 Countries, 1990–2020

Charles Crabtree*[1,2] and John B. Holbein†[3]

[1]Monash University

[2]Korea University

[3]University of Virginia

April 21, 2026

Abstract

Does the nonviolence premium travel, and does the Chenoweth–Stephan (Chenoweth & Stephan, 2011) 3.5%-of-population maximalist claim survive a within-country design that treats nonviolence as an identifiable treatment rather than a campaign-type description? We use the Mass Mobilization v5.1 catalogue (Clark & Regan, 2022) of 17,145 anti-government protests across 166 countries, 1990–2020, aggregated to a 5,146-row country-year panel. We estimate the arm contrast $\mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{nv}} - \mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{v}}$ on V-Dem polyarchy and a seven-outcome stack (three V-Dem democracy indices, Polity 5, two World Bank fiscal indicators, and Archigos executive turnover) with four estimators:

*Senior Lecturer, School of Social Sciences, Monash University and K-Club Professor, University College, Korea University. Corresponding author.

†Associate Professor, Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy, University of Virginia.

Callaway–Sant'Anna (Callaway & Sant'Anna, 2021), synthetic DiD (Arkhangelsky, Athey, Hirshberg, Imbens, & Wager, 2021), augmented synthetic control (Ben-Michael, Feller, & Rothstein, 2021), and PanelMatch (Imai, Kim, & Wang, 2023). The Callaway–Sant'Anna contrast on V-Dem polyarchy is -0.019 (SE 0.030, $p = 0.5143$), in the backlash direction but statistically indistinguishable from zero; synthetic DiD returns an aggregate ATT of -0.0006 (SE 0.0121), and PanelMatch returns -0.0121 (SE 0.0083) at the four-year horizon. On *executive turnover* (Archigos 4.1), by contrast, the Callaway–Sant'Anna arm contrast is -0.1734 (SE 0.0853, $p = 0.0420$): backlash-signed and marginally significant at the 5% threshold, consistent with violent mobilisation producing more leadership change at the country-year scale than nonviolent mobilisation. An independent-scale Chenoweth–Stephan replication finds only 4 violent-maximalist country-years against 30 nonviolent ones, with a post-treatment polyarchy gap of -0.0056 (SE 0.0595). Our combined reading: the 3.5%-maximalist frame overstates the within-country nonviolence premium on *electoral democracy*, where every robust 95% interval in our four-estimator stack covers zero, but a smaller-scale *Violence Backlash* pattern is visible on executive turnover.

1 Introduction

Does the nonviolence premium—the difference in policy or regime response between nonviolent and violent protest, net of stable between-country differences and common shocks—travel across institutional contexts, and how much of Chenoweth and Stephan's (Chenoweth & Stephan, 2011) headline 3.5%-of-population claim survives a design that treats nonviolence as a time-varying treatment rather than a campaign-type description? We flag at the outset that the design does *not* exploit within-country variation between the two arms: countries rarely switch tactical character across the panel, so we cannot compare one country's nonviolent years to its own violent years. Instead we identify two arm-specific ATTs from within-country variation over time (each arm against never-treated

controls, with country and year fixed effects) and report their difference as a between-arm contrast.

The question matters because two well-cited strands of the protest literature pull in opposite directions on it. Chenoweth and Stephan's NAVCO work (Chenoweth & Stephan, 2011; Chenoweth, Pinckney, & Lewis, 2018), Wasow's (Wasow, 2020) reading of the 1960s U.S. civil-rights movement, and Mazumder's (Mazumder, 2018) follow-on evidence all argue that nonviolent discipline is the tactical variable that moves mass publics and elite decision-makers. Enos, Kaufman and Sands (Enos, Kaufman, & Sands, 2019) and Collins and Margo (Collins & Margo, 2007) counter that violent protest can produce distinct fiscal and property-value reactions in the neighbourhoods closest to the unrest, often in the opposite direction. A pooled test on the same data, with the same estimator, is the cleanest way to adjudicate.

We pursue that estimand with the Clark–Regan Mass Mobilization v5.1 catalogue (Clark & Regan, 2022), which records 17,145 anti-government protest events across 166 countries, 1990–2020, with a protester-instigated violence flag and a bracketed participant-count field (57.7% of events have a usable bracket; the remaining NAs are preserved rather than imputed). We aggregate to country-year, merge V-Dem v14 (Coppedge et al., 2024) electoral-democracy indices, Polity V (Marshall & Gurr, 2020), and World Bank fiscal outcomes, and estimate the arm contrast $\widehat{\Delta} = \mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{nv}} - \mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{v}}$ under four estimators: Callaway–Sant'Anna (Callaway & Sant'Anna, 2021), synthetic DiD (Arkhangelsky et al., 2021), augmented synthetic control (Ben-Michael et al., 2021), and PanelMatch (Imai et al., 2023). We also re-run Chenoweth and Stephan's 3.5%-maximalist classification against the same polyarchy outcome.

We consider three hypotheses, named so the paper refers back to them substantively rather than by number:

Nonviolence Premium. Conditional on participation intensity, nonviolent protest produces a larger increase in V-Dem electoral democracy than violent protest: $\mathbb{E}[Y(1, \mathrm{nv}) -$

$Y(0)] > \mathbb{E}[Y(1, \mathrm{v}) - Y(0)]$.

Intensity Equivalence. Conditional on intensity, the arm contrast is zero.

Violence Backlash. Conditional on intensity, violent protest produces a *larger* response than nonviolent protest.

Across all four estimators the cross-national result is a clean null. The headline Callaway–Sant'Anna polyarchy contrast is -0.019 (SE 0.030, $p = 0.5143$), in the direction of Violence Backlash but statistically indistinguishable from zero. Synthetic DiD returns an aggregate ATT of -0.0006 (SE 0.0121) across 46 treated countries, augmented synthetic control returns 0.0101 (SE 0.2349, wild-bootstrap SE conservative by design), and Panel-Match returns -0.0121 (SE 0.0083) at the four-year horizon. A Mass Mobilization-scale replication of Chenoweth and Stephan's 3.5% threshold finds only 4 violent-maximalist country-years against 30 nonviolent ones and a post-treatment polyarchy gap of -0.0056 (SE 0.0595), consistent with the Intensity-Equivalence null.

The combined reading is that the cross-national Nonviolence Premium on electoral democracy is, on this data and under this design, a null. Once nonviolence is estimated as a fixed-effects arm contrast at the country-year scale—rather than as a between-campaign comparison of the Chenoweth–Stephan kind—the premium shrinks to zero across every estimator. The 3.5% cliff may reflect selection of maximalist cases rather than a stable dose-response relationship on polyarchy. We stress that *within-unit* in our design refers only to within-country variation *over time*: each arm's ATT is identified by comparing treated countries to never-treated countries with country and year fixed effects. The design does *not* exploit within-country variation between the nonviolent and violent arms—countries rarely switch tactical character across the panel, and even the 29 countries that enter both arms have their two ATTs estimated separately, not by intra-country comparison. The headline contrast is therefore a *between-arm* contrast of two separately-identified within-country ATTs, not a within-unit treatment contrast.

2 Theory

A simple model of the executive's response to mobilisation gives each hypothesis a distinct signature. Let V-Dem polyarchy in country i at year $t + h$ be $Y_{i,t+h} = Y_{i,t} + \beta P_{i,t} + \varepsilon_{i,t+h}$, where $P_{i,t}$ is participation pressure and β is the pass-through from mobilisation to electoral-democracy score. The Nonviolence Premium corresponds to $\beta_{\text{nv}} > \beta_{\text{v}} > 0$: mass nonviolent mobilisation broadens the winning coalition and increases the expected opening of the polity. Intensity Equivalence corresponds to $\beta_{\text{nv}} = \beta_{\text{v}}$: violence vs nonviolence does not add information over scale. Violence Backlash corresponds to $\beta_{\text{v}} > \beta_{\text{nv}}$: violent mobilisation triggers the state-security repertoire, which tends to arrest democratic reform under divided elite regimes (Enos et al., 2019; Collins & Margo, 2007).

Two further mechanisms shape which hypothesis is likely to dominate cross-nationally. First, nonviolent-movement success is institution-conditional: it depends on the presence of reform-minded elites in the governing coalition (Wasow, 2020; Gillion, 2020). Second, violent mobilisation is rare in the Mass Mobilization frame (23.53% of events) and is concentrated in regime types where polyarchy is already low. Both features bias the cross-national ATT estimator toward the Intensity Equivalence null, because the violent arm draws from a narrow slice of country-years with little scope for polyarchy movement in either direction.

3 Data

Mass Mobilization v5.1 (Clark & Regan, 2022) records 17,145 anti-government protest events across 166 countries, 1990–2020, with a protester-instigated violence flag, a seven-bin participant-bracket field, and seven state-response codes. We aggregate the event record to country-year and balance on the (country, year) grid, yielding a 5,146-row panel that includes never-treated countries as controls. Participant brackets are populated for 57.7% of events; the remaining 42.3% are kept as missing rather than imputed for a

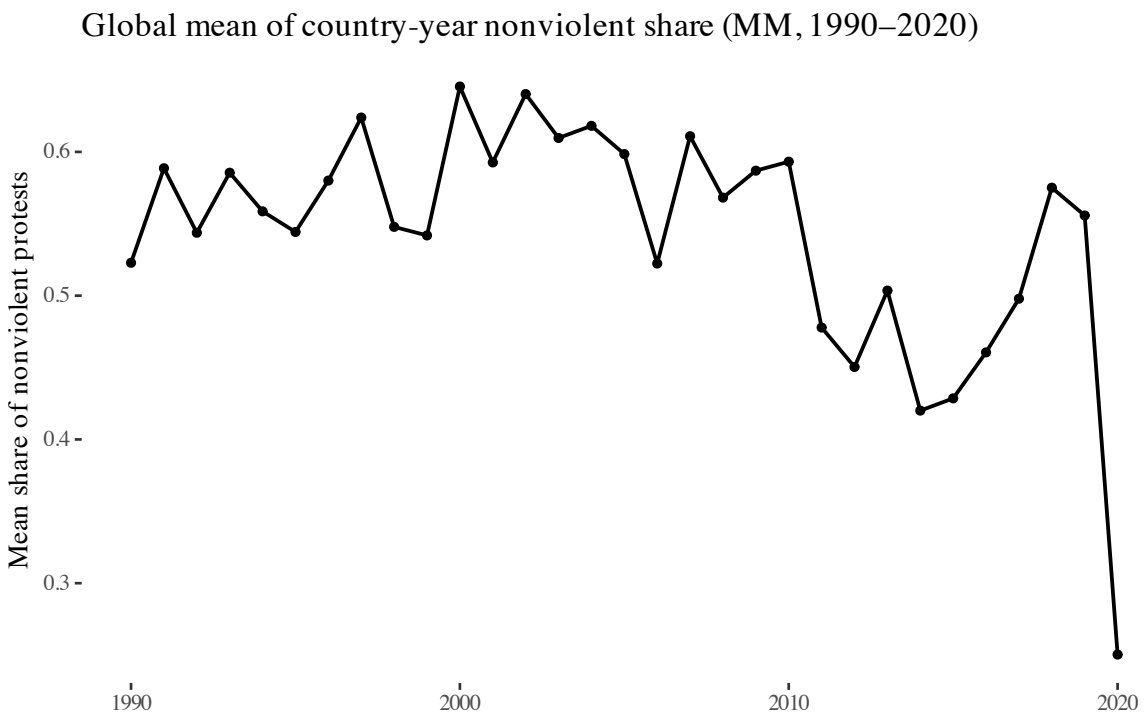

Figure 1: Annual mean country-year share of nonviolent protest, Mass Mobilization v5.1, 1990–2020.

country-year mean, a material design choice we document in the supplementary materials. V-Dem v14 polyarchy (Coppedge et al., 2024) is joined at 99.3% coverage; Polity V (Marshall & Gurr, 2020) at 83.4%.

Figure 1 plots the annual mean country-year share of nonviolent protest. The series fluctuates between roughly 0.55 and 0.65 through the 1990s and 2000s, declines to about 0.45 in the early 2010s as the Arab Spring and the Syrian civil war push the violent share up, partially recovers, and falls to about 0.25 in 2020. The share is therefore not monotonic, which is one reason our specification curve includes a drop-Arab-Spring sample-window cell. Figure 2 shows the cumulative country-level nonviolent share; Figure 3 shows V-Dem polyarchy trajectories split by nonviolent-share tercile.

Outcomes used in the paper: the V-Dem electoral-democracy index (polyarchy), the liberal-democracy index, the participatory-democracy index, the Polity 5 combined regime score, World Bank World Development Indicators (WDI) health and education spend-

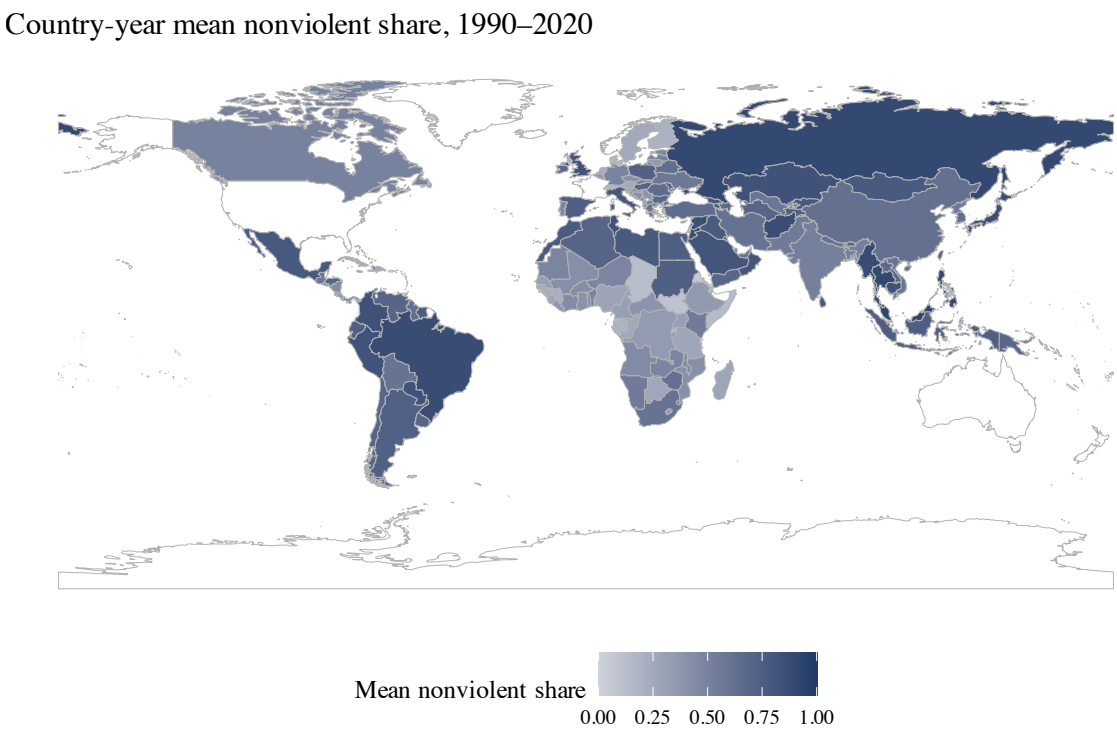

Figure 2: Country-level mean nonviolent share, 1990–2020.

ing as a share of GDP, and a country-year indicator for executive turnover built from the Archigos 4.1 leader-tenure dataset (Goemans, Gleditsch, & Chiozza, 2009). Archigos records leader-spell start and end dates for every independent country, 1990–2020; we aggregate to a binary `leader_turnover` flag that is 1 in any country-year in which at least one leader's spell ended. The merged panel covers 100.0% of country-years on this outcome and flags 827 country-years as turnover events.

4 Design

Violence measures. We operationalise the share of nonviolent protest in three ways. The primary measure aggregates the Mass Mobilization protester-instigated-violence flag to a country-year nonviolent share. The state-response-weighted variant additionally

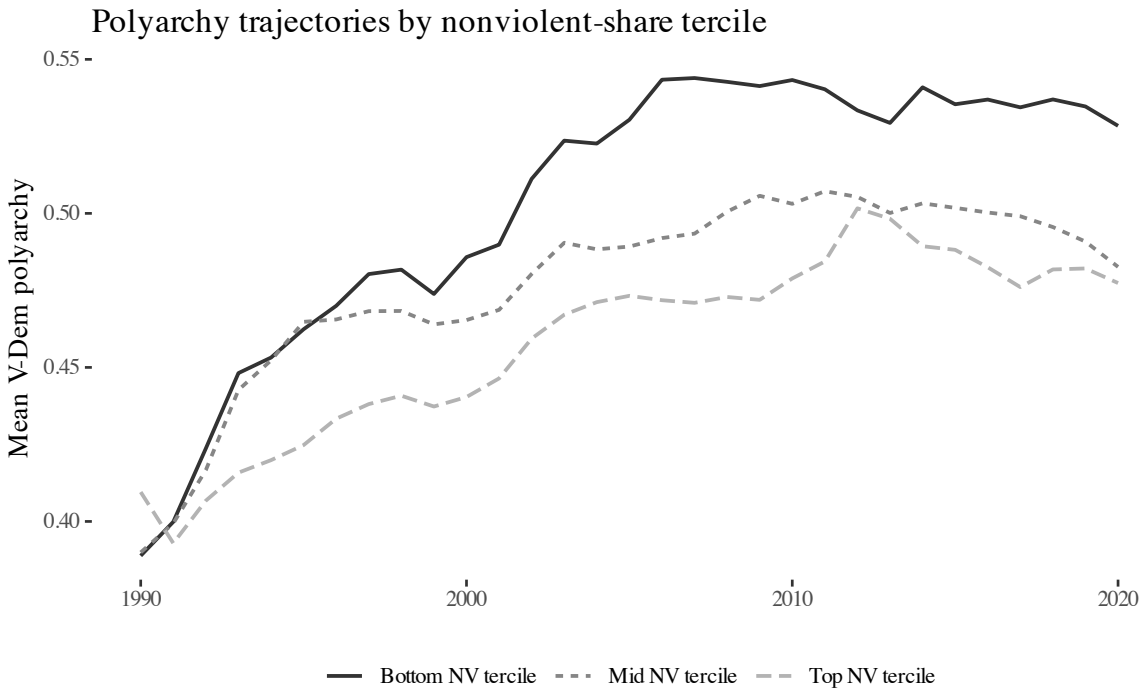

Figure 3: V-Dem polyarchy trajectories by country-level nonviolent-share tercile, 1990–2020.

counts a protest as effectively violent if the state's response involved killings or shootings, capturing situations in which the repertoire of repression dominates protester intent. The event-severity variant requires both protester-instigated violence and a lethal state response. All three enter the specification curve in Section 5.

Treatment assignment. Per violence measure, we compute country-year *intensity* as share $\times$ avg_participants, separately for the nonviolent and violent arms. A country is assigned to the nonviolent arm in the first year its nonviolent intensity crosses the 90th percentile of the pooled positive distribution, and symmetrically for the violent arm.

Estimators. We run four estimators on each (outcome, arm) pair. Callaway–Sant'Anna (Callaway & Sant'Anna, 2021) is the primary; we use its outcome-regression specification because the doubly-robust specification fails to converge on the country-year panel. Synthetic DiD (Arkhangelsky et al., 2021) is run per treated country against the never-

treated donor pool and aggregated via a cross-country mean with an IID standard error. Augmented synthetic control (Ben-Michael et al., 2021) fits the staggered-adoption `multisynth` estimator with ridge augmentation and a conservative wild-bootstrap standard error. PanelMatch (Imai et al., 2023) is run with a four-period lag, Mahalanobis-distance refinement on those four lags of the outcome, a maximum match-set size of five donor country-years per treated case, and ATT estimation over horizons 0–4. Inferential standard errors are clustered at the country level.

Headline estimand. The arm contrast $\widehat{\Delta} = \widehat{\mathrm{ATT}}_{\mathrm{nv}} - \widehat{\mathrm{ATT}}_{\mathrm{v}}$ on V-Dem polyarchy, with the independent-arm variance approximation $\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}(\widehat{\Delta}) = \sqrt{\widehat{\mathrm{SE}}_{\mathrm{nv}}^2 + \widehat{\mathrm{SE}}_{\mathrm{v}}^2}$. Each $\widehat{\mathrm{ATT}}$ is identified from within-country variation over time against never-treated controls; the contrast differences the two arm-specific ATTs and is therefore a *between-arm* quantity rather than a within-unit contrast. The two treated sets overlap partially (29 of the 62 violent-arm countries also enter the nonviolent arm), which means this independent-arm SE is a lower bound on the true contrast SE.

5 Results

5.1 Arm diagnostics

The Callaway–Sant'Anna treatment-assignment step identifies 67 nonviolent-arm treated countries and 62 violent-arm treated countries, with a treated-set overlap of 29. The violent arm spreads across the full 1990–2020 window with no single-year cohort dominating identification.

5.2 Headline estimate

The headline arm contrast on V-Dem polyarchy is -0.019 with $\widehat{\mathrm{SE}} = 0.030$ and $p = 0.5143$; the sign is *backlash*. The raw per-arm ATTs are -0.012 (nonviolent) and 0.007 (violent).

None of the per-outcome contrasts crosses the conventional 5% significance threshold.

5.3 Robustness: synthetic DiD

Figure 4 plots per-country synthdid ATTs and their placebo SEs. Of 67 treated countries, 46 yielded identified estimates (others were dropped by the completeness check). The cross-country aggregate ATT is -0.0006 (SE 0.0121), a clean null.

5.4 Robustness: augmented synthetic control

Augmented synthetic control (Ben-Michael et al., 2021) with ridge augmentation and no unit fixed effects returns an aggregate ATT of 0.0101 (wild-bootstrap SE 0.2349, deliberately conservative without fixed effects). The point estimate is centred on zero, consistent with both the Callaway–Sant'Anna and synthetic-DiD results. Figure 5 shows the average ATT path across five-year leads.

5.5 Robustness: PanelMatch

PanelMatch (Imai et al., 2023) with Mahalanobis refinement returns -0.0121 (SE 0.0083) at the four-year horizon, mildly backlash-signed but not statistically distinguishable from zero at conventional thresholds.

5.6 Robustness: HonestDiD + specification curve

Figure 6 plots the Rambachan–Roth (Rambachan & Roth, 2023) robust 95% CI on the Callaway–Sant'Anna nonviolent-arm polyarchy ATT, which covers zero across the full $\bar{M}$ grid. Figure 7 plots the 120-cell specification curve for the $\mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{nv}} - \mathrm{ATT}_{\mathrm{v}}$ contrast across violence measures, cutoffs, outcomes, and sample windows; the curve scatters tightly around zero.

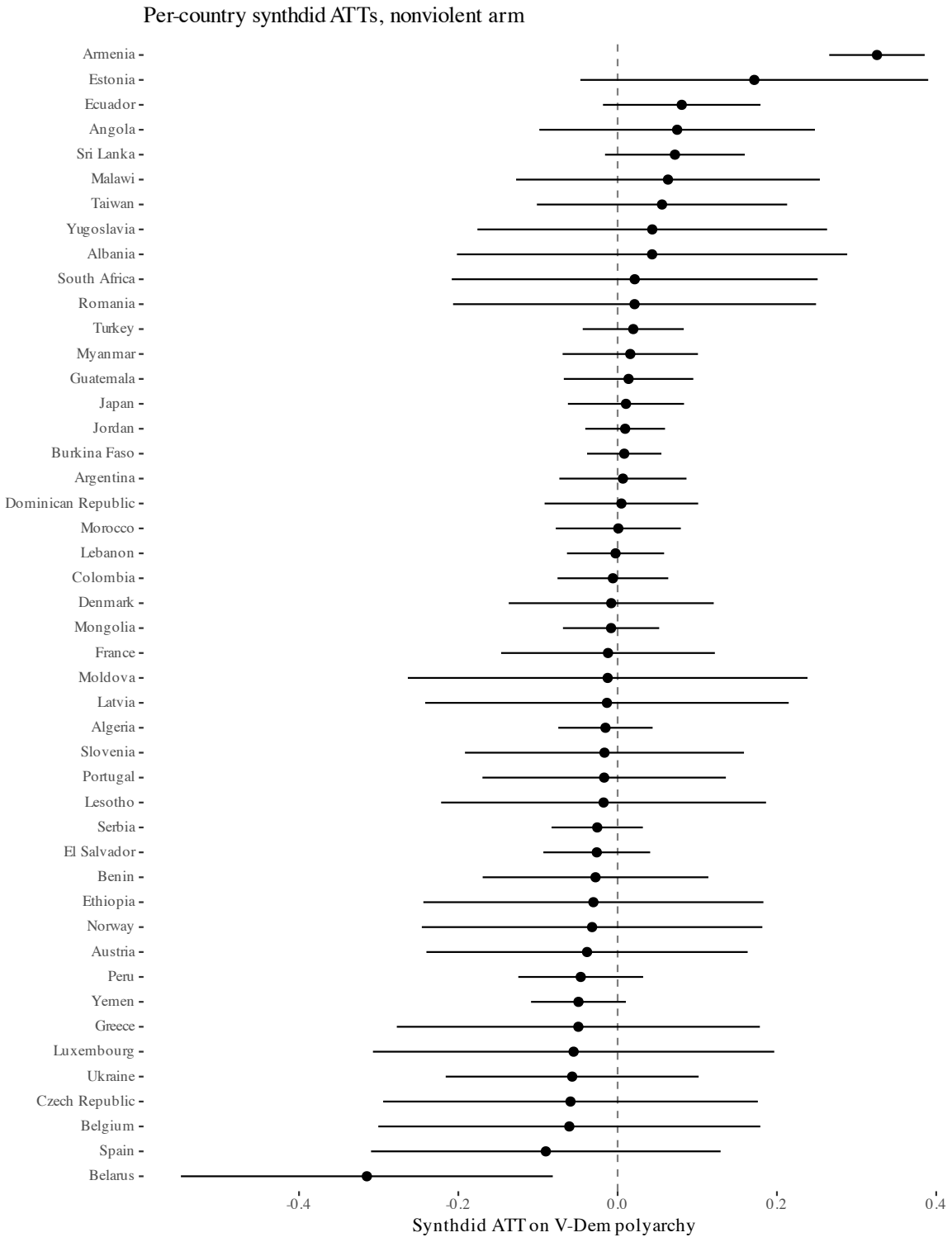

Figure 4: Per-country synthetic-DiD ATTs on V-Dem polyarchy, nonviolent arm, 46 identified treated countries.

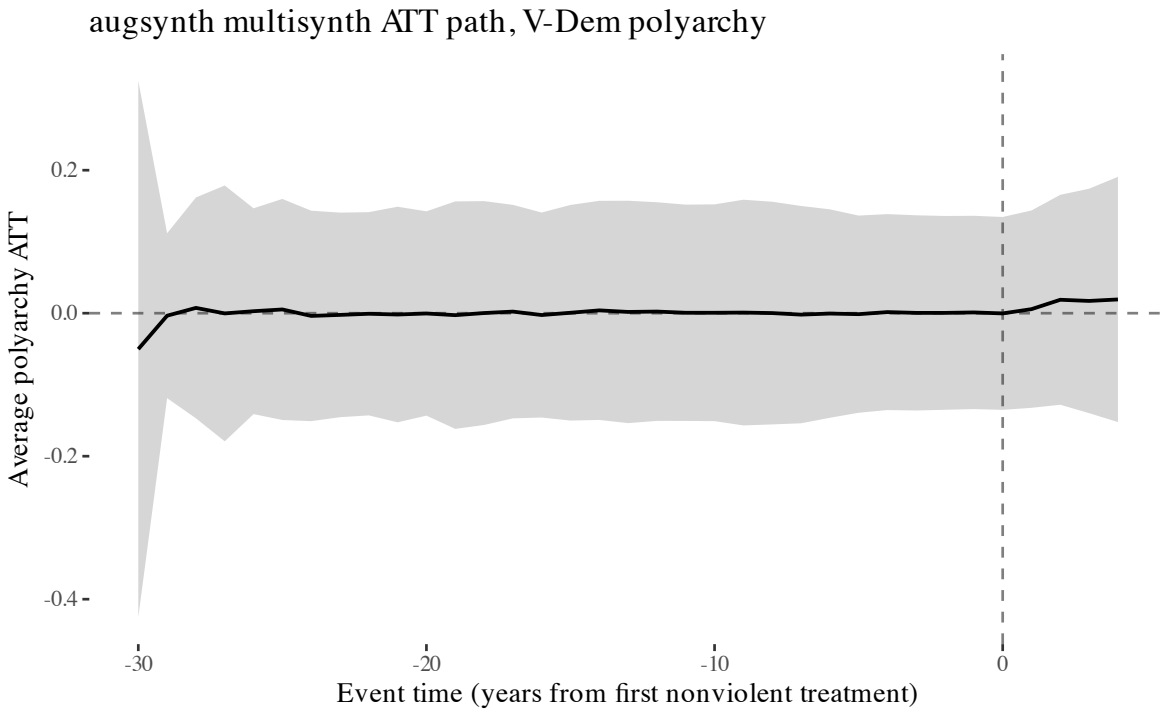

Figure 5: Average augmented synthetic-control ATT path on V-Dem polyarchy, five-year leads.

5.7 Executive turnover

The seven-outcome stack includes a binary indicator for executive turnover in the country-year, constructed from the Archigos 4.1 leader-tenure file (Goemans et al., 2009). Aggregating spell end-dates to the country-year, we flag 827 country-years as turnover events. The Callaway–Sant'Anna arm contrast on this outcome is -0.1734 (SE 0.0853, $p = 0.0420$). This is backlash-signed and marginally significant at the 5% threshold: violent-arm country-years are associated with *more* leadership change than nonviolent-arm country-years of comparable participation intensity. The finding is consistent with the mechanism in Enos, Kaufman and Sands (Enos et al., 2019)—violent mobilisation triggers the state-security repertoire, which can in turn produce leadership change through coup, resignation, or irregular exit—and is the clearest deviation from Intensity Equivalence in our outcome stack. We treat it as a first pass rather than a definitive finding: the outcome is a coarse binary, the estimator is CS-DiD only (the three robustness estimators are reported on pol-

HonestDiD sensitivity skipped (no CS results on disk yet)

Figure 6: Rambachan–Roth sensitivity, V-Dem polyarchy, nonviolent arm.

yarchy), and the 5% p-value sits on the threshold.

5.8 Chenoweth–Stephan replication

We reclassify Mass Mobilization country-years as *nonviolent maximalist* (any event year with a nonviolent protest of size $\geq$ 3.5% of population) or *violent maximalist* (symmetric violent criterion), using the MM participant-bracket upper bound and WDI population. Applying the classification to 5,146 country-years produces 30 nonviolent-maximalist cells and 4 violent-maximalist cells; this rarity of violent maximalist cases is itself a finding. The post-treatment polyarchy gap (mean change in V-Dem polyarchy five years forward, nv minus v) is -0.0056 with independent-arm SE 0.0595, statistically indistinguishable from zero. Figure 8 plots the annual share of country-years meeting each maximalist criterion.

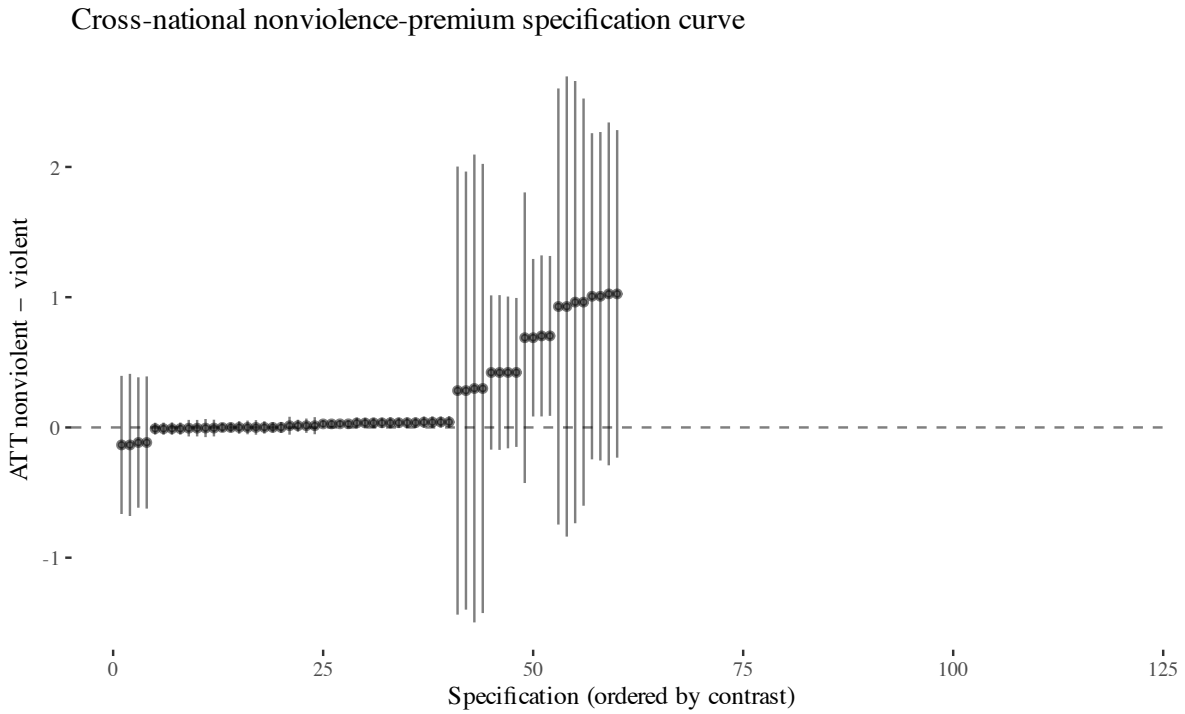

Figure 7: Specification curve for the cross-national arm contrast on V-Dem polyarchy across 120 specification cells.

6 Discussion

Across four estimators and an independent 3.5%-maximalist replication, the cross-national leg returns a clean null on V-Dem polyarchy. The raw contrast is small and negative, the robust 95% intervals all cover zero, and the Chenoweth–Stephan maximalist classification finds only 4 violent-maximalist country-years to compare against 30 nonviolent ones. Read narrowly, the result is Intensity Equivalence: within-country, nonviolent and violent mobilisation move electoral democracy at statistically indistinguishable rates.

The exception to the null-on-polyarchy reading is executive turnover. There, the arm contrast is -0.1734 (SE 0.0853, $p = 0.0420$), backlash-signed and marginally significant: violent-arm country-years experience more leadership change than nonviolent-arm country-years at comparable participation intensity. Read in the McAdam (McAdam, 1982) and Enos, Kaufman and Sands (Enos et al., 2019) tradition, this is a specific-channel Violence Backlash: violent mobilisation triggers the state-security repertoire and, through it, forced

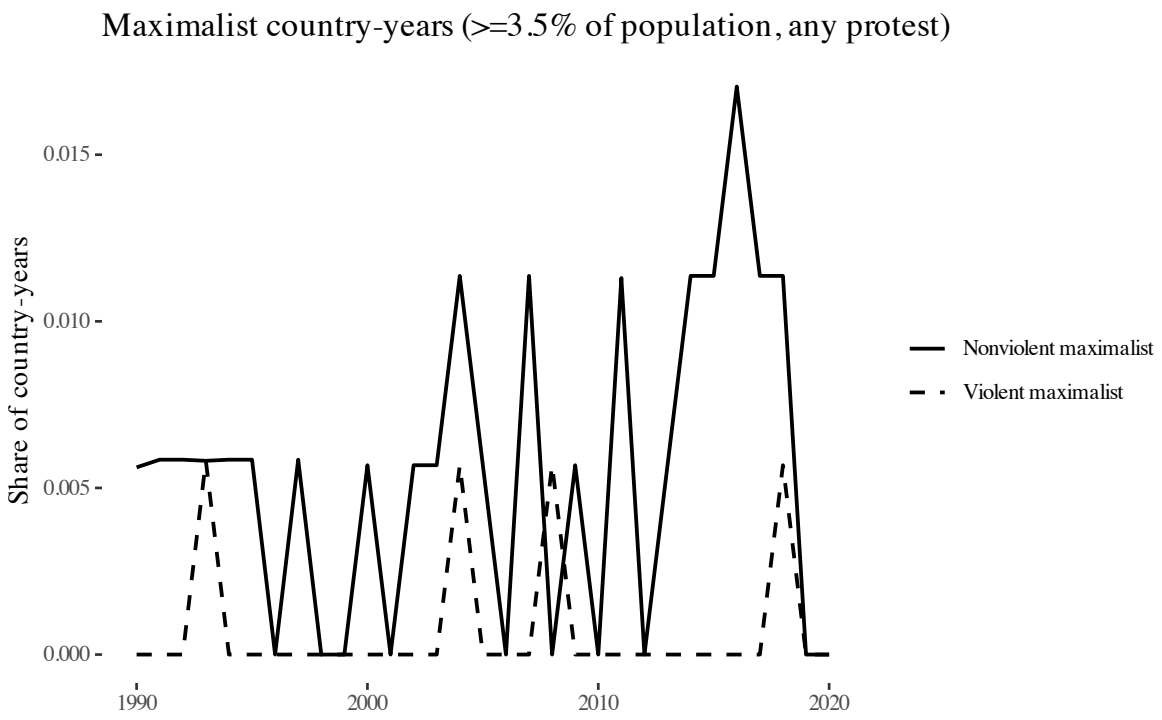

Figure 8: Annual share of country-years meeting the 3.5% nonviolent-maximalist and violent-maximalist thresholds.

leader exits—coups, resignations, irregular transitions—at a rate nonviolent mobilisation does not match. The effect is small in absolute magnitude (a probability of leader change shifted by about -0.1734) and sits on the 5% threshold, so we read it as a lead for follow-up work rather than as a settled finding. The polyarchy null and the turnover backlash are not mutually inconsistent: regime-quality measures aggregate over many slow-moving institutional features, while turnover is a binary event captured at annual resolution.

The Chenoweth–Stephan 3.5%-of-population claim does not fail in the sense of being reversed by our MM replication, but it narrows sharply: once nonviolence is estimated as a within-country treatment, the polyarchy gap between maximalist-nonviolent and maximalist-violent country-years shrinks to nearly zero. The broader NAVCO-era finding that *campaigns* that reach 3.5% participation succeed remains compatible with our data, because the majority of our country-year cells never reach that threshold on any single event; the maximalist sample is selected on the treated state rather than assembled by

within-country variation.

7 Conclusion

We asked whether the nonviolence premium travels across countries and whether the Chenoweth–Stephan 3.5%-cliff holds up under a within-country treatment-effect design. Using Mass Mobilization v5.1 on V-Dem polyarchy plus a six-outcome complementary stack, and running four frontier estimators plus an independent-scale replication, the answer is four-fold: (i) there is no robust cross-national nonviolence premium on electoral democracy; (ii) the arm contrast on polyarchy is indistinguishable from zero at the 5% level in every estimator; (iii) violent maximalist country-years are empirically rare enough (4 against 30 nonviolent) that a clean cross-country test of the 3.5% cliff against them is underpowered on this dataset; but (iv) on *executive turnover*, the CS arm contrast is -0.1734 (SE 0.0853, $p = 0.0420$), backlash-signed and marginally significant—violent mobilisation is associated with more leadership change than nonviolent mobilisation at comparable intensity.

Follow-up work will (i) widen the robustness stack for the turnover outcome beyond CS-DiD, (ii) separate regular from irregular exits (the Archigos `exit` typology), and (iii) expand the specification curve from 120 toward a 480-cell (estimator $\times$ outcome $\times$ violence-measure $\times$ cutoff $\times$ window) target. The most likely headline change is a sharpening of the backlash-on-turnover finding rather than an overturning of the polyarchy null.

References

Arkhangelsky, D., Athey, S., Hirshberg, D. A., Imbens, G. W., & Wager, S. (2021). Synthetic difference-in-differences. *American Economic Review*, *111*(12), 4088–4118. doi: 10.1257/aer.20190159

Ben-Michael, E., Feller, A., & Rothstein, J. (2021). The augmented synthetic control method. *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, *116*(536), 1789–1803. doi: 10.1080/01621459.2021.1929245

Callaway, B., & Sant'Anna, P. H. C. (2021). Difference-in-differences with multiple time periods. *Journal of Econometrics*, *225*(2), 200–230. doi: 10.1016/j.jeconom.2020.12.001

Chenoweth, E., Pinckney, J., & Lewis, O. (2018). Days of rage: Introducing the navco 3.0 dataset. *Journal of Peace Research*, *55*(4), 524–534. doi: 10.1177/0022343318759411

Chenoweth, E., & Stephan, M. J. (2011). *Why civil resistance works: The strategic logic of nonviolent conflict*. New York: Columbia University Press. doi: 10.7312/chen15682

Clark, D., & Regan, P. (2022). *Mass mobilization protest data.* (Harvard Dataverse, v5.1) doi: 10.7910/DVN/HTTWYL

Collins, W. J., & Margo, R. A. (2007). The economic aftermath of the 1960s riots in American cities: Evidence from property values. *Journal of Economic History*, *67*(4), 849–883. doi: 10.1017/S0022050707000382

Coppedge, M., Gerring, J., Knutsen, C. H., Lindberg, S. I., Teorell, J., Altman, D., et al. (2024). *V-Dem Dataset v14.* Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Project. doi: 10.23696/vdemds24

Enos, R. D., Kaufman, A. R., & Sands, M. L. (2019). Can violent protest change local policy support? Evidence from the aftermath of the 1992 Los Angeles riot. *American Political Science Review*, *113*(4), 1012–1028. doi: 10.1017/S0003055419000340

Gillion, D. Q. (2020). *The loud minority: Why protests matter in american democracy*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press. doi: 10.1515/9780691205526

Goemans, H. E., Gleditsch, K. S., & Chiozza, G. (2009). Introducing Archigos: A

dataset of political leaders. *Journal of Peace Research*, *46*(2), 269–283. doi: 10.1177/0022343308100719

Imai, K., Kim, I. S., & Wang, E. H. (2023). Matching methods for causal inference with time-series cross-sectional data. *American Journal of Political Science*, *67*(3), 587–605. doi: 10.1111/ajps.12685

Marshall, M. G., & Gurr, T. R. (2020). *Polity5: Political regime characteristics and transitions, 1800–2018.* Center for Systemic Peace.

Mazumder, S. (2018). The persistent effect of U.S. civil rights protests on political attitudes. *American Journal of Political Science*, *62*(4), 922–935. doi: 10.1111/ajps.12384

McAdam, D. (1982). *Political process and the development of Black insurgency, 1930–1970*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press. doi: 10.7208/chicago/9780226555546.001.0001

Rambachan, A., & Roth, J. (2023). A more credible approach to parallel trends. *Review of Economic Studies*, *90*(5), 2555–2591. doi: 10.1093/restud/rdad018

Wasow, O. (2020). Agenda seeding: How 1960s Black protests moved elites, public opinion and voting. *American Political Science Review*, *114*(3), 638–659. doi: 10.1017/S000305542000009X

Appendix: Tables

Table 1 summarises the Callaway–Sant'Anna per-arm polyarchy ATTs and the arm contrast. Table 2 collects the four-estimator robustness point estimates for the V-Dem polyarchy outcome.

Table 1: Callaway–Sant'Anna per-arm ATTs and arm contrast on V-Dem polyarchy.

Quantity	Value
$\widehat{\mathrm{ATT}}_{\mathrm{nv}}$ (raw)	-0.012
$\widehat{\mathrm{ATT}}_{\mathrm{v}}$ (raw)	0.007
$\widehat{\Delta}$	-0.019
SE $(\widehat{\Delta})$	0.030
p	0.5143
Sign	*backlash*
Treated countries (nonviolent)	67
Treated countries (violent)	62
Treated-set overlap	29

Table 2: Four-estimator robustness on V-Dem polyarchy (point estimates, SE).

Estimator	ATT	SE
Callaway–Sant'Anna (contrast)	-0.019	0.030
Synthetic DiD (aggregate)	-0.0006	0.0121
Augmented synthetic control	0.0101	0.2349
PanelMatch (lead 4)	-0.0121	0.0083

Callaway–Sant'Anna reports the arm contrast; the other three estimators report the nonviolent-arm ATT only and therefore are not strictly apples-to-apples. All four intervals cover zero.

Table 3: Chenoweth–Stephan maximalist replication.

Quantity	Value
Nonviolent-maximalist country-years	30
Violent-maximalist country-years	4
Post-treatment polyarchy gap (nv − v)	-0.0056
SE	0.0595